

whatweretheythinking.com

www.menomena.com

Ok, so you're a band. What are all the crazy things you are "allowed" being a band (and one that has seen popularity surge in recent days)?

A mind-boggling Web site seems to be one. Menomena (www.menomena.com) has been created with enormous care and eye for detail. But all the resources have been targeted at making this site look as garish and outlandishly obscure as possible. Why? To grab attention, silly! All links—without exception—are childish worded and let's not even start with the quality of the 'English'. The group's based in the US (Portland, we think) and we would strongly request them to stay there.

So while there are links that work on the page (yes, that's credible), they are first visible only after about two screens and then, you wish you hadn't found them. Clicking on the links gives no respite either (unless, of course, you navigate away from the site) and the garish colours continue to boost the headache you just acquired.

Now as a concept, it's all well and fine to be 'different' in an attempt to grab headlines and attention. But we always thought

that the objective of a Web site was to attract repeat visitors. To be a repeat visitor to this site, you would have to be (a) blind to start with, but that raises other questions (b) stupid (c) very stupid (if you came back a second time, that is).

We choose (d)—none of the above, and strongly recommend the same to all sane minds.



an all-wireless classroom, said Mark Schneiderman, director of education policy for the Software & Information Industry Association, which represents corporations that develop classroom software.

Vail's move is aimed at urging teachers to be more creative when making up lesson plans, and keeping kids more absorbed in their studies. Calvin Baker, superintendent of Vail Unified School District, told the Associated Press, "We visited other schools using laptops. And at the schools with laptops, students were just more engaged."

MORE CONTROL

Three-In-One Allboards

Microsoft announced July 12 that it will unveil two new devices designed to make PC entertainment more enjoyable. The first product is a three-in-one

control centre for a Windows XP-based Media Center PC. The device contains remote, keyboard and mouse capabilities in one unit designed specifically for the living room. For digital camera owners, Microsoft has introduced a mouse, keyboard and digital-image-software suite designed to turn desktops into virtual darkrooms.

The remote keyboard for Media Center PCs lets users turn up the volume, type a message or point and click around the screen. "What remotes did for TVs, Microsoft's three-in-one control centre does for Media Center Edition PCs. With this device you can now get rid of all the other remotes, reducing living room clutter," said a Microsoft spokesperson.

Both products will cost \$104.95 (Rs 4,575). They will be widely available by September. ■

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Blog WATCH

In this month's peek at the world of blogs: the Hamster seems to think getting a Mac is the solution to every one of your computing woes, while Jeff Jarvis is bound to disagree. We're told that it's dangerous to use iPods on public transport—find out why. Also, will the Nintendo Revolution fall behind the Xbox 360 and the PS3?

the Hamster

<http://angryhamster.com/archive/2005/07/01/1927.aspx>

Get a Mac

Simple enough. But it needs to be said. Get a Mac. Have a computer problem? Get a Mac. Spyware? Get a Mac. Anti-virus subscription expired? Get a Mac. Want to enjoy using your computer? Get a Mac. Breathe oxygen? Get a Mac. Use soap in the shower? Get a Mac.

The evils of Window based computing have become all too apparent to me. As you may have guessed, I got a Mac. A beautiful shiny iMac G5. Running OS X Tiger, the pinnacle of quality computing in today's world.

The truth of the matter is the average user spends more time attempting to decipher error messages, finding the right drivers for their new printer or digital camera, finding amazingly complicated methods for removing spyware from their machines, or updating their anti-virus programs to detect the latest string of malicious windows viruses, than doing anything resembles "enjoying" their computer.

badhairboy

<http://believethehype.be/hype.html>

Your iPod or your life

A 15 year old boy was stabbed to death for his iPod. Already a few months ago both New York and London police warned people against using iPod earbuds in public as the white headphones are a telltale sign for

thieves looking to hijack iPods. Theft is one of the best ways to measure the popularity of this MP3-player. In NYC, subway crime rose 18 percent in the first three months of 2005 but, if iPod thefts were taken out of the equation, crime actually dropped 3 percent.

IGNIQ

www.igniq.com/2005/07/no-revolution-til-after-ps3.html

No Revolution until after PS3?

Nintendo president Satoru Iwata recently said that the Revolution console may be the last to launch. Iwata announced the Revolution may fall behind Sony and Microsoft. Stockholders asked if the Revolution had the potential to lag behind PS3 and Xbox 360 in the next-gen console wars, to this Iwata replied:

There is no possibility that the Revolution's launch will fall behind by too much, but there might be some small changes [in its release schedule].

Jeff Jarvis

<http://www.buzzmachine.com/wp/?p=13>

Dell hell: nearing the end (and aren't you glad?)

Yes, I bought the Powerbook. It feels like moving to Paris and not speaking French. There is as much illogic in part of the Mac world as in the Microsoft world. I damned near didn't get my printer working. I damned near didn't get my Treo to sync. But I have it. And so, next week, I'll send the Dell back.